ADRIAN CIOANCA

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McKinsey & Company, APD Recruiting Team
McKinsey & Company
Sydney / Canberra, Australia

Dear McKinsey APD Recruiting Team,

I am applying to the Associate role through the Advanced Professional Degree pathway. A short version of how I got here: I finished my PhD with the Frank Fenner Medal, awarded to one PhD out of a cohort of 103 at the John Curtin School of Medical Research, then led a 7-person team that went on to publish 25 papers together. The part I actually enjoyed most was not the publication count, it was the team itself, coordinating 20 research groups across 7 universities toward one result. Working directly with industry changed things again. Delivering a preclinical model for Merck & Co. and a programme for Beta Therapeutics, I enjoyed it even more, using data and a bit of creativity to solve a real problem for a client with a business outcome attached to it, not just a publication. That is when I realised I wanted to do consulting properly, so I moved to Accenture to work with bigger clients on bigger problems.

Why McKinsey

- The APD pathway exists because McKinsey has found that people who spend years running an independent, ambiguous research problem end up well suited to running a client workstream the same way. That is the exact pattern of my recent work: I built and defended a commercial valuation for a biotech asset, then walked a compliance team through why an AI system's flagged clause actually mattered. I want to run that pattern inside McKinsey's case-team model instead of alone.
- Client delivery at Accenture is the part of this transition most APD candidates take on faith; I already have it, working directly with compliance and Defence stakeholders rather than assuming it will transfer.

What I bring

- My PhD ran statistical modelling across 50M+ observations under peer review, rigour that earned me promotion to Level B in 1.5 years against a typical 4-5 year track, and the same discipline I now bring to scoping a client's problem before committing to an approach.
- As co-founder of a biotech spin-off I built the DCF and risk-adjusted NPV case for our lead candidate myself, raised $670K in non-dilutive funding, and led the scientific strategy that secured 3 national patents.

I would welcome the chance to discuss how this background fits the Associate class you are building through the APD pathway. I am flexible on Sydney or Canberra and happy to provide any further materials your team needs. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Adrian Cioanca